of a convertible couch. How would we fill six rooms?

In addition, my parents' apartment didn't have the usual amenities of modernity. For instance, a refrigerator did not come with it. We would have to buy one and, in fact, the moment we decided to move, we began shopping and, on August 29, bought a refrigerator for delivery on October 1. It cost us $225 and it was rather a revelation to me that the time had come when I could consider such purchases as possible. Nine years before a bill of $60 for the purpose of fixing my teeth had seemed so impossible that the only practical alternative seemed to have been to let my teeth rot.

On occasion we would drop in at my parents' and watch new flooring being put down in the apartment they were going to use, and new wall sockets; then we would go out and shop for a bed.

Such problems are not colossal. There are many worse things than having to take the trouble to buy items you can afford for a new living space far more spacious than your old and scarcely any the more expensive. It was, however, tedious. Neither Gertrude nor I enjoyed shopping, and I myself was trying to organize my research into an acceptable dissertation and was also trying to finish "Grow Old with Me," my most ambitious writing undertaking since 'The Mule." I hated the time it took to shop and I hated the general dislocations of moving.

A welcome break came toward the end of the month of August.

It was time for the annual world science-fiction convention—the fifth. I had missed the second, third, and fourth, which were held in far-distant places such as Chicago and Denver. The fifth, however, was to be held in Philadelphia, and heaven knows I could reach that.

To be sure, the world science-fiction convention had become a multiday affair held over the Labor Day weekend. What with the ques-

tion of moving and shopping filling our thoughts and our days, we could not go for the entire weekend, but we could manage one day-Saturday, August 30, 1947.

We took the 9:00 a.m. train to Philadelphia and visited Meisel to begin with. After a small lunch we went to the hotel where the convention was in progress. I greeted many of the people whom I already knew well—Campbell and de Camp, notably—to say nothing of newer friends such as George O. Smith and Sam Merwin.